

SAFE OPERATING PROCEDURE

Battery charger

LOCATION: Various

TOI-OHOMAI
Institute of Technology

PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT



Version: 2	Key Contact: George Fisher
Effective Date: 18/09/2020	Speciality/Position: Technician
Review Date: December 2022	Contact number: 021 190 4236
Permits required: N/A	Confined space ☐ Hot Works ☐ Working at Heights ☐

HAZARDS ASSOCIATED WITH THIS EQUIPMENT

PERMANENT HAZARDS Remove as necessary	List	Control Method	Lock out Yes or No
Manual handling	Heavy batteries	Use two people for lifting heavy batteries. Lifting handle are for lowering and lifting batteries into and out of cars, and for carrying batteries around.	No
Explosion	Hydrogen sulphide emitted from charging batteries highly flammable	Use charger in ventilated room, no naked flames, do not cover charging battery	No
Hazardous materials	Hydrogen sulphide gas emitted during charging is dangerous to inhale. Burns from battery acid Battery acid is harmful to clothing	Do not lean over battery when charging and keep room well ventilated. Wear gloves for handling, treat all wet areas as acid, wipe all spills and discard cloths. Keep batteries away from clothing when carrying/transporting.	No

PURPOSE/PROCESS

Charging batteries

PROCEDURES:

DO NOT use this equipment unless you have proven to your trainer that you are competent in its safe use and operation

Pre Start Check

1. Ensure there are no sources of ignition or naked flames in the vicinity
2. Ensure the power is switched off at the mains and on the charger, before fitting or removing battery.
3. If caps on battery are removable, remove and check water level (top up if low).
4. With power turned off, fit the clips to the correct terminals on the battery.
5. **Positive (+) Red** Negative (-) Black
6. Do not let the clips touch each other
7. Select the correct voltage setting on the charger: 6V, 12V or 24V

Operation

1. Turn on the power to the charger at the wall then switch charger power on
2. Start with the lowest setting then slowly move to the correct setting
3. Do not lean over the battery when charging
4. If testing for charge is to be done, use a hydrometer

Close Down

1. Turn off the power switch on the charger then turn off the power at the wall
2. Remove the clips ensuring they do not touch and store
3. If caps have been removed, replace
4. Store charger and leave area tidy

	Name	Title/Position	Signature	Date
Author	George Fisher	Technician		
Reviewed by	Marie Dennis	HSW Manager		
Reviewed by	Tony Middlemiss	Health and safety rep		
Manager	Joe Nathan			

Document Control

Date	Revision number	Modifications	Revised by	Approved by
3/12/2019	1	New template	George Fisher	Marie Dennis
10.03.20	2	Updated	George Fisher	